

FAMILY STUDIES

OVERVIEW

In the social sciences and humanities curriculum, family studies is a multidisciplinary subject area that encompasses four areas: fashion and housing; food and nutrition; general family studies; and raising and caring for children. The topics covered in these areas include, among others: textile production; the functions and design of clothing; the fashion industry; issues related to housing; interior design; the role of nutrition in health; the relationship between food and culture; human and family interactions and development; life management skills; various types of relationships; and considerations related to raising and caring for children.

In family studies courses, students learn about laws and policies that affect individuals and families in Canada and around the world. They also become familiar with the theoretical perspectives and practical research that underpin our understandings of individual and family development. Family studies courses also integrate theory and practical skills. Many expectations can be achieved through practical experiences both in the classroom and in co-op placements, some of which may be affiliated with Specialist High Skills Majors programs.

All courses in family studies encourage students to develop critical and creative thinking skills. Students are given opportunities to deepen their understanding of relevant issues and to develop practical skills, including research and inquiry skills. Students are encouraged to explore a range of perspectives and approaches and to develop the habits of mind that enhance individual, family, and community well-being and contribute to lifelong learning.

GENERAL FAMILY STUDIES

Personal Life Management, Grade 12

Open

HIP40

This course focuses on preparing students for living independently and working successfully with others. Students will learn to manage their personal resources to meet their basic needs for food, clothing, and housing. They will also learn about their personal, legal, and financial responsibilities and develop and apply interpersonal skills in order to make wise and responsible personal and occupational choices. Students will apply research and inquiry skills while investigating topics related to personal life management. The course emphasizes the achievement of expectations through practical experiences.

Prerequisite: None

A. RESEARCH AND INQUIRY SKILLS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

Throughout this course, students will:

- A1. Exploring:** explore topics related to personal life management, and formulate questions to guide their research;
- A2. Investigating:** create research plans, and locate and select information relevant to their chosen topics, using appropriate social science research and inquiry methods;
- A3. Processing Information:** assess, record, analyse, and synthesize information gathered through research and inquiry;
- A4. Communicating and Reflecting:** communicate the results of their research and inquiry clearly and effectively, and reflect on and evaluate their research, inquiry, and communication skills.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. Exploring

Throughout this course, students will:

- A1.1** explore a variety of topics related to personal life management (*e.g., careers, consumer rights, rights of employees and employers, economic trends, investment options, credit-card options, financial services*) to identify topics for research and inquiry

- A1.2** identify key concepts (*e.g., through discussion, brainstorming, use of visual organizers*) related to their selected topics

- A1.3** formulate effective questions to guide their research and inquiry

Teacher prompt: “If you wanted to understand the role of unions, why might it be important to learn about the perspectives of both workers and management?”

A2. Investigating

Throughout this course, students will:

- A2.1** create appropriate research plans to investigate their selected topics (*e.g., outline purpose and method; identify sources of information*), ensuring that their plans follow guidelines for ethical research

- A2.2** locate and select information relevant to their investigations from a variety of primary sources (*e.g., interviews, observations, surveys, questionnaires, original documents in print and other media – film, photographs, songs, advertisements*) and/or secondary sources (*e.g., textbooks, newspaper or magazine articles, book reviews, research reports, websites, brochures*)

Teacher prompt: “What criteria would you use to determine the best secondary source for your research?”

- A2.3** based on preliminary research, for each investigation formulate a hypothesis, thesis statement, or research question, and use it to focus their research

A3. Processing Information

Throughout this course, students will:

- A3.1** assess various aspects of information gathered from a variety of primary and secondary sources (*e.g., accuracy, relevance, reliability, inherent values and bias, voice*)

Teacher prompts: “What strategies can you use to determine the relevance of the information you have gathered?” “If two information sources contradict each other, how might you determine which is more reliable?”

A3.2 record and organize information and key ideas using a variety of formats (*e.g., notes, graphic organizers, summaries, audio/digital records*)

A3.3 analyse and interpret research information (*e.g., compare results of surveys and interviews; determine whether common themes arise in different sources*)

A3.4 demonstrate academic honesty by documenting the sources of all information generated through research

A3.5 synthesize findings and formulate conclusions (*e.g., weigh and connect information to determine the answer to their research question*)

A4. Communicating and Reflecting

Throughout this course, students will:

A4.1 use an appropriate format (*e.g., oral presentation, podcast, brochure, poster, report, multimedia presentation, web page*) to communicate the results of their research and inquiry effectively for a specific purpose and audience

A4.2 use terms relating to personal life management correctly (*e.g., resources, budgeting, goal setting, consumerism*)

A4.3 clearly communicate the results of their inquiries (*e.g., write clearly, organize ideas logically, use language conventions properly*), and follow APA conventions for acknowledging sources (*e.g., generate a reference list in APA style*)

A4.4 demonstrate an understanding of the general research process by reflecting on and evaluating their own research, inquiry, and communication skills

Teacher prompts: “How might the research methods you used have affected the results you obtained?” “What steps might you take to enhance your research/inquiry skills?”

B. SELF AND OTHERS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. Progressing From Adolescence to Adulthood:** demonstrate an understanding of the personal qualities and skills necessary to make the transition from adolescence to adulthood;
- B2. Planning for Employment:** describe the elements of successful planning for employment;
- B3. Communicating Effectively:** demonstrate an understanding of effective communication skills and their role in building the healthy relationships that support independent living.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. Progressing From Adolescence to Adulthood

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1.1** compare the roles of adolescents and adults, and identify responsibilities they themselves will assume and personal qualities they will require as they take on adult roles

Teacher prompt: “How are expectations for an adult’s behaviour different from those for an adolescent?”

- B1.2** identify their personal short-term and long-term goals and the essential skills and knowledge needed to achieve them
 - B1.3** explain the importance of initiative, persistence, and motivation in achieving personal goals
 - B1.4** explain how pursuing opportunities for ongoing learning (e.g., taking additional courses such as First Aid, CPR, computer applications) can help them achieve their personal goals and contribute to future success
- Teacher prompt:** “How might CPR or First Aid certification help in gaining employment?”
- B1.5** explain the importance of building a network of human resources to support independent living (e.g., friends, mentors, community organizations)

Teacher prompts: “Why is it important to have supports outside the family when living on one’s own?” “Why would someone outside the family be best to turn to for legal assistance?”

B2. Planning for Employment

By the end of this course, students will:

- B2.1** identify occupations available in fields related to their personal skills, interests, values, and attributes
- B2.2** summarize the steps required for obtaining desirable employment (e.g., recording their own work experience to build a portfolio/résumé; identifying skills, interests, and educational achievements; preparing or revising a résumé and letter of application; collecting references)

B3. Communicating Effectively

By the end of this course, students will:

- B3.1** identify the components of verbal and non-verbal communication (e.g., choice of vocabulary and level of language, tone of voice, body language and manner of self-presentation, physical distance, appropriate physical contact, choice and use of written/electronic media)
- B3.2** describe different styles of communication (e.g., passive, aggressive, passive aggressive, assertive), and identify their strengths and weaknesses

Teacher prompt: “How would you make a consumer complaint using an aggressive communication style? An assertive style? How might the outcome differ depending on the style you adopted?”

B3.3 describe barriers to effective communication (e.g., noise, misinterpretations, interruptions, distractions, interference, bias, stereotyping)

Teacher prompt: “How do non-verbal cues sometimes contradict verbal messages?”

B3.4 describe techniques for communicating effectively (e.g., listening actively, using “I” messages, maintaining open body language, maintaining a positive attitude, choosing an appropriate level of assertiveness, acknowledging the perspective of the other person)

B3.5 explain how cultural awareness and understanding can assist communication

Teacher prompt: “How does understanding the cultural or religious views of others help individuals communicate respectfully?”

B3.6 identify common causes of conflict in interpersonal relationships (e.g., power inequalities, power struggles, gossip, rumours, differing opinions or values, feelings of disrespect)

B3.7 determine which models of conflict resolution (e.g., acquiescence, mediation, compromise, collaboration, synthesis) are most appropriate for resolving different types of conflicts

Teacher prompts: “For which types of conflict would mediation be most appropriate? For which types of conflict would mediation be ineffective or potentially risky?” “Which model of conflict resolution is the easiest to use?”

B3.8 apply appropriate conflict-resolution skills to resolve interpersonal conflicts

Teacher prompt: “At work, if you felt you were not being treated the same as other employees by your employer, what would be an appropriate approach to dealing with the problem?”

C. DAILY LIVING SKILLS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. Making Decisions:** demonstrate an understanding of effective decision-making processes and their role in independent living;
- C2. Managing Financial Resources:** explain and demonstrate the use of basic money-management skills and techniques needed to manage personal financial resources effectively;
- C3. Managing a Household:** describe and demonstrate the use of basic principles and techniques of effective household management.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

C1. Making Decisions

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1.1** evaluate the effectiveness of some common approaches to decision making (*e.g., acting on impulse, adopting a laissez-faire attitude, flipping a coin, setting priorities, weighing alternatives*)

Teacher prompts: “What types of decisions are you used to making? What strategies have you used? Were they effective?” “What types of decisions are you likely to be faced with in the future? What strategies might be appropriate for making those decisions?”

- C1.2** identify an appropriate decision-making model, use it to make a particular personal choice, and evaluate its effectiveness

- C1.3** explain how a variety of factors (*e.g., resources; personal, family, and community values; individual goals, abilities, and interests*) can influence an individual’s decision-making process

Teacher prompt: “What factors might influence a consumer’s decision to buy or not buy environmentally friendly products?”

- C1.4** analyse the relationship between effective decision making and personal well-being

Teacher prompts: “How might making effective decisions in one area of life affect other areas of life?” “How could weekly planning of nutritious meals help improve your overall health and financial status?”

C2. Managing Financial Resources

By the end of this course, students will:

- C2.1** explain factors that affect the use of money as a resource (*e.g., basic needs, personal needs, wants, goals, priorities*)

- C2.2** demonstrate the use of effective money-management strategies (*e.g., budgeting, banking, responsible credit card use, bank statement reconciliation*)

- C2.3** explain the reasons for setting aside a portion of income as savings (*e.g., to prepare for emergencies, to plan for future purchases, to maintain their home, to save for education or retirement*)

Teacher prompts: “Why is it important to establish the habit of saving as soon as you start to receive an income?” “What factors can make regular saving a challenge?”

- C2.4** demonstrate the use of strategies for effectively managing finances and planning next steps if they are unable to earn sufficient income to support themselves and/or their families

- C2.5** explain the advantages and disadvantages of buying on credit (*e.g., commitment of future income; positive and negative effects on credit rating; risks of repossession, garnishment of wages, or bankruptcy; purchase protection*)

Teacher prompt: “How might over-reliance on credit lead to an unmanageable debt load and put your financial stability at risk?”

C3. Managing a Household

By the end of this course, students will:

- C3.1** describe the basic components of a home environment that is safe and adequate for their needs
- C3.2** describe the basic responsibilities involved in maintaining a safe and functional home environment (*e.g., conserving water and energy, recycling, reducing waste, making informed decisions about the use of toxic household products, making minor home repairs, storing flammable liquids safely, ensuring that smoke detectors and fire extinguishers are in working order, planning escape routes*)

C3.3 demonstrate the skills required to acquire and maintain a functional personal wardrobe (*e.g., budgeting for purchases, caring for clothing, altering and repairing clothing*)

C3.4 demonstrate the skills required to plan and safely prepare healthy meals (*e.g., budgeting for food, shopping for groceries, using Nutrition Facts tables and food labels to make healthy food choices, preparing nutritious meals, using small appliances appropriately, practising food and kitchen safety*)

D. PERSONAL AND SOCIAL RESPONSIBILITIES

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1. Personal Responsibilities:** demonstrate an understanding of the role of personal responsibility in independent living, and of strategies that can be used to meet individual needs;
- D2. Workplace Rights and Responsibilities:** demonstrate an understanding of the rights and responsibilities of employers and employees, including both personal and legal responsibilities;
- D3. Consumer Rights and Responsibilities:** demonstrate an understanding of the role that responsible consumerism plays in living independently.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

D1. Personal Responsibilities

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1.1** describe the various ways individuals meet their basic food needs (*e.g., budgeting for food, making healthy food choices, planning meals, buying locally produced food, applying food safety techniques, recognizing the importance of breakfast, contacting community organizations that provide assistance*)
- D1.2** explain the various ways individuals meet their basic clothing needs (*e.g., wardrobe planning, laundering clothing, contacting community organizations that provide assistance, shopping at used-clothing stores*)
- D1.3** explain the various ways individuals meet their basic housing needs (*e.g., choosing appropriate housing alternatives, budgeting for shelter, maintaining a safe and clean home, contacting community organizations that provide assistance*)
- D1.4** identify personally relevant legal documents, records, and areas of law (*e.g., insurance policies, wills, leases, health records, insurance records, the Landlord and Tenant Act, municipal by-laws*), and describe their importance

Teacher prompts: “Why is it important to know one’s rights as a tenant?” “Why are car owners required to have automobile insurance?” “How does having insurance help reduce the risk to your resources?” “Why is it important to make a will?”

- D1.5** identify strategies for maintaining a healthy balance between work and personal life (*e.g., managing stress, prioritizing activities, making time for self and family, being physically active, getting enough sleep, maintaining healthy relationships, contributing to the community*)

D2. Workplace Rights and Responsibilities

By the end of this course, students will:

- D2.1** explain the importance of maintaining a positive attitude and self-image in the workplace
Teacher prompt: “How can feeling good about oneself alleviate workplace stress?”
- D2.2** explain the importance of ethics and honesty in the workplace
Teacher prompts: “How does acting with integrity improve an employee’s relationship with other employees and the employer?” “How does acting with honesty affect a company’s ability to attract business?”
- D2.3** identify the rights and responsibilities of employees and employers
- D2.4** identify policies, laws, and government regulations related to health and safety in the workplace (*e.g., employee manuals, workplace safety policies, the Workplace Hazardous Materials Information System, the Ontario Occupational Health and Safety Act*)

D2.5 describe key provisions of legislation that governs labour relations and unions in the workplace (e.g., *the Employment Standards Act, the Ontario Human Rights Code*)

D2.6 explain the benefits of taking training in preventing and/or addressing harassment and violence in the workplace

Teacher prompt: “How can understanding the components of harassment help to improve workplace relationships and working conditions?”

D3. Consumer Rights and Responsibilities

By the end of this course, students will:

D3.1 describe strategies for making responsible consumer decisions when living independently (e.g., *prioritizing needs and wants, comparison shopping, reading warranties and contracts, considering the environmental impact of purchases, reading information labels*)

D3.2 identify internal and external factors that influence spending decisions (e.g., *personal preferences, convenience, cultural values, status-related motives, advertising, product cost and availability, environmental impact, considerations related to labour and exploitation issues*)

D3.3 identify the basic products and services needed to support independent living (e.g., *furnishings, utility services, communication services, staple goods, household equipment, consumable goods, insurance*)

D3.4 evaluate retail shopping opportunities available within their community as sources of basic products and services (e.g., *catalogue shopping, retail stores, convenience stores, outlet malls, home shopping channels on television, Internet shopping, buying clubs, bulk warehouse purchasing, farmers’ markets*)

Teacher prompt: “What criteria would you use to determine whether an Internet site or a retail store was the best place to purchase a computer?”

D3.5 demonstrate the use of effective techniques for making consumer complaints (e.g., *writing letters of complaint; contacting a customer-relations department, the ombudsman, or the Better Business Bureau; reporting to appropriate authorities*)

E. ECONOMICS AND PERSONAL FINANCES

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- E1. Economic Influences:** demonstrate an understanding of how global, national, and community economic factors affect the individual's financial circumstances;
- E2. Financial Institutions:** describe ways in which financial institutions can assist in the management of personal finances;
- E3. Benefits and Costs of Working:** explain the benefits and costs of working.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

E1. Economic Influences

By the end of this course, students will:

- E1.1** explain the impact of various economic changes on individual finances (*e.g., changes in interest rates, consumer prices, employment rates; fluctuations in the value of the dollar; inflation; border closures; changes in the supply of or demand for various commodities*)
- E1.2** analyse the impact of employment changes on personal finances (*e.g., layoffs, long strikes, downsizing, plant closures, promotions*)
- E1.3** identify and describe strategies they can use to plan for and manage unexpected financial crises (*e.g., saving money, making investments, owning property, borrowing money, using credit, preventing and/or repairing the damage from identity theft and fraud*)

Teacher prompts: "How can taking measures to keep accurate records help you avoid significant problems if you lose your wallet?" "How can setting money aside help to reduce the impact of an unexpected home repair?"

E2. Financial Institutions

By the end of this course, students will:

- E2.1** identify various types of financial institutions in the community (*e.g., banks, credit unions, finance companies, trust companies, the stock market*)

- E2.2** compare the products and services offered by a variety of financial institutions (*e.g., debit cards, credit cards, lines of credit, loans, mortgages, investment instruments, automatic teller machines, financial advisers*)

Teacher prompt: "Which financial institution has the best combination of products and/or services to meet your current needs?"

E3. Benefits and Costs of Working

By the end of this course, students will:

- E3.1** identify the economic and personal costs associated with working for pay (*e.g., cost of clothing and uniforms, safety equipment, tools, transportation, food, childcare; job-related stress or illness; limited time to meet personal needs*)
- E3.2** explain the benefits of working for pay (*e.g., opportunities to: make a living; develop relationships/networks; strengthen interpersonal skills; increase competencies; obtain personal gratification and/or satisfaction through making a contribution; offset feelings of boredom; expand professional skills, knowledge, and experience*)
- Teacher prompts:** "If finances were not a concern, why might some people still choose to work?" "How does working teach transferable skills that can increase an individual's employability?"
- E3.3** explain the typical deductions from a paycheque (*e.g., union dues, income tax, employment insurance, private pension, Canada Pension Plan*)

E3.4 identify the types of benefits employers might offer as part of a job contract (*e.g., supplementary health insurance, life insurance, pension, paid vacation, sick leave, skills-upgrading programs*)

E3.5 describe various alternatives to regular full-time employment (*e.g., self-employment, contract work, part-time work, job sharing, multiple jobs*)

E3.6 identify the additional financial arrangements workers in alternative employment need to make (*e.g., planning for retirement; purchasing injury, accident, and supplementary health insurance; saving for income tax*)

RAISING AND CARING FOR CHILDREN
